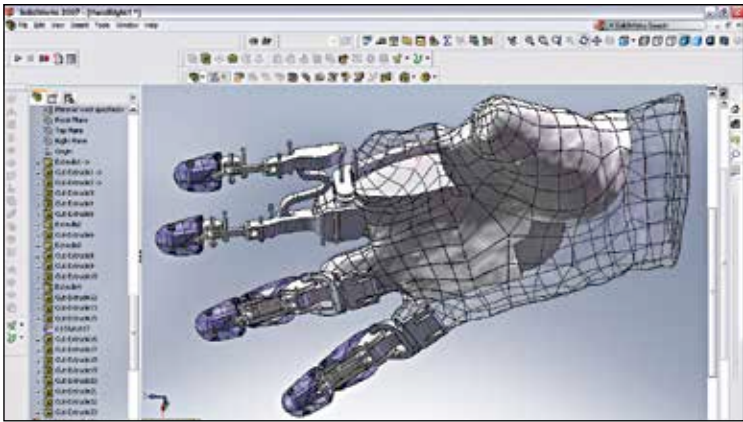




As one of the next generation of 3D printer oriented CAD programs, Solidworks has the best of solid and surface modeling features.

and gives users a good sense of the 3D design workflow. It also works with Google Earth to import a scaled photograph which can then be tweaked for added fun and engagement.

3DCrafter

3DCrafter comes with a real-time drag and drop approach to 3D modelling which is also useful for 3D animation projects. The intuitive and easy to use system is available as freeware with more advanced paid versions as well.

Blender

Blender is another free open source 3D design program that is popular for 3D asset creation. Compared to other free programs it is perhaps the most powerful and feature rich of them all and is comparable to even commercial paid for programs. It has a steeper learning curve but is an excellent intermediate software for those who wish to use free software with advanced features.

BRL-CAD

BRL-CAD is also a very powerful open source CAD program that focuses solely on solid modeling design with features such as interactive geometry editing, advanced geometric analysis, system performance analysis, benchmarking tools and a library of geometric shapes. Interestingly, it was originally